GRAMMARFIRST · FREE SAMPLE

Irish Grammar Compact

22 lessons from A1 to B2 with rules, examples, tips and exercises. Answers included.



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How this workbook works

Grammar is the frame of a language. Once you understand the rules, you can build your own sentences instead of memorising phrases. This workbook walks you through the essential grammar of Irish step by step.

Every lesson has four parts: the **rule**, the **structure** at a glance, **examples** with translation and a **tip**. Then come five **exercises**. The answers are at the end of the workbook.

The chapters follow the levels of the Common European Framework: A1, A2 and B1. At the end of a level you have worked through its grammar once completely.

With the GrammarFirst app you can practise every lesson interactively too, with audio, spaced review and Mila the marmot.

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Free sample: lessons 1 to 3 of 22. Get the full workbook at fabio-ecosystem-ashy.vercel.app/grammarfirst/premium

Unit 1 · Basics

A1

1 Tá: to be

'Tá' (is, am, are) describes states and places. In Irish the verb comes at the start of the sentence.

> **Tá + subject + complement**

Tá mé go maith.	I'm fine.
Tá sí sa bhaile.	She is at home.
Tá an aimsir go hiontach.	The weather is wonderful.

Tip Word order verb, subject, object: the verb always comes first.

Exercises

1. **I am tired.**
   a) Tá mé tuirseach. b) Mé tá tuirseach. c) Tuirseach tá mé.
2. **___ sé go maith. (He is doing well.)**
   a) Tá b) Is c) An
3. **Translate: The cat is black.**

   _____
4. **Match**

   1. mé ..... A. I
   2. tú ..... B. you
   3. sé ..... C. she
   4. sí ..... D. he
5. **'I'm fine' → Tá mé go ___** _____

2 The article an

Irish has only one definite article: 'an' (plural 'na'). There is no indefinite article.

> **an + noun · with feminine nouns often lenition: bean → an bhean**

an cat	the cat
an bhean	the woman (bean → bhean)
cat	a cat

Tip 'cat' on its own already means 'a cat'.

Exercises

1. **'a cat' in Irish:**
   a) an cat b) cat c) un cat
2. **'the woman' (bean):**
   a) an bean b) an bhean c) na bean
3. **'the cat': ___ cat** _____
4. **Plural article:**
   a) an b) na c) na h-
5. **Translate: The cat is here.**

_____

3 Is: the copula

For identity, profession and nationality you don't use 'tá' but the copula 'is'. Then comes the noun, then the person.

> **Is + noun + pronoun · Is múinteoir mé. · Is dochtúir í. · Negative: Ní múinteoir é.**

Is múinteoir mé.	I am a teacher.
Is Éireannach í.	She is Irish.
Ní dochtúir é.	He is not a doctor.

Tip After 'is', he and she are 'é' and 'í', not 'sé' and 'sí'.

Exercises

1. **I am a student:**
   a) Tá mé mac léinn. b) Is mac léinn mé.
2. **Is dochtúir ___. (she)**
   a) sí b) í c) é
3. **I'm fine:**
   a) Is maith mé. b) Tá mé go maith.
4. **___ múinteoir é. (He is not a teacher.)** _____
5. **Translate: I am Irish.**

_____



Want more?

19 more lessons with answers are waiting in the full workbook.

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